

CASE ID: 201906710002

EPISODE NAME: China Discourages Tourism to the US 2019

2019/06/03 - 2019/12/31

Sender: China (710)

Target: United States (2)

Issue: Improve Human Rights (8)

Final Outcome: Capitulation by Sender after Imposition (8)

Narrative:

On 2019/06/03, China, through its Ministry of Education, sanctioned the U.S. by warning Chinese students studying abroad of an increased likelihood that the U.S. would impose restrictions on their student visas.¹ This had the potential to discourage Chinese students from studying in the U.S.. China also imposed a similar sanction through its Ministry of Foreign Affairs on 2019/06/04 by advising Chinese citizens to be safe when working in, studying in, and traveling to the United States, alleging US authorities had been conducting increased checks to harass Chinese citizens traveling to and from China². China's Ministry of Culture and Tourism issued an alert for Chinese citizens the same day, warning: "Recently, shootings, robberies and theft have occurred frequently in the U.S."³

This was most likely in response to a new U.S. Department of State policy going into effect on 2019/06/01 which required most applicants for U.S. visas to submit identifying info for their phone, email, and social media communication.⁴ Even earlier than this on 2019/01/03, the Department of State issued a Level 2 travel advisory, warning that China was arbitrarily using exit bans to harass U.S. citizens, forcing them to remain in China sometimes for years.⁵ Of note is the fact that this Level 2 advisory had been in place from the year prior, and was reintroduced in 2019 to include information about exit bans.⁶

As the warnings to Chinese citizens by the Ministry of Education and the Ministry of Culture and Tourism were effective until 2019/12/31, that is when China's sanctions ended.⁷ There were no further escalations of travel warnings by the US or China based on these events.

¹ Cheng, Evelyn. "China warns citizens against travel to the US." *CNBC*, June 4th, 2019. <https://www.cnbc.com/2019/06/04/china-warns-citizens-against-travel-to-the-us.html>.

² Cheng, Evelyn. "China warns citizens against travel to the US." *CNBC*, June 4th, 2019. <https://www.cnbc.com/2019/06/04/china-warns-citizens-against-travel-to-the-us.html>.

³ Ibid.

⁴ "US now seeking social media details from all visa applicants." *AP News*, June 1st, 2019. <https://apnews.com/united-states-government-travel-c96a215355b242e58107c2125c18fc4a>.

⁵ Ibid.

⁶ Hansler, Jennifer. "US warns travelers of China's 'coercive' use of exit bans." *CNN*, January 3rd, 2019. <https://www.cnn.com/2019/01/03/politics/state-department-china-advisory-2019/index.html>.

⁷ Falconer, Rebecca. "'Frequent shootings': China warns citizens against travel to U.S." *Axios*, June 4th, 2019. <https://www.axios.com/2019/06/04/china-issues-travel-warning-for-us-citing-shootings>.